

**SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF BRONX**

Index No.:**CHRISTIAN RIVERA,**

Plaintiff,

Date Purchased:**Date Filed:**

– against –

SUMMONS**CITY OF NEW YORK, NEW YORK CITY POLICE
DEPARTMENT, POLICE OFFICER VICTOR
MARRERO, POLICE OFFICER JOHN DOE and
POLICE OFFICER JOHN ROE,**Plaintiff designates Bronx County as the
place of trial. The basis of venue is the
action arose in Bronx County.

Defendant(s).

TO THE ABOVE NAMED DEFENDANTS:

YOU ARE HEREBY SUMMONED to answer the Verified Complaint in this action and to serve a copy of your answer, or, if the complaint is not served with this summons, to serve a notice of appearance on the Plaintiff's attorney within 20 days after the service of the summons, exclusive of the day of service or within 30 days after the service is complete if this summons is not personally delivered to you within the State of New York; and in case of your failure to appear or answer, judgment will be taken against you by default for the relief demanded in the notice set forth below and in the within Verified Complaint.

Date: Bronx, New York
March 9, 2016**NEIL WOLLERSTEIN, ESQ.**Attorney for Plaintiff
895 Sheridan Avenue
Bronx, New York 10451
(718) 588-1300

TO: ZACHARY CARTER, ESQ.
Corporation Counsel of City Of New York
100 Church Street
New York, NY 10007

NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT
1 Police Plaza
New York, NY 10038

POLICE OFFICER VICTOR MARRERO (Shield No. 20392)
41st Precinct
1035 Longwood Avenue
Bronx, NY 10457

POLICE OFFICER JOHN DOE
New York City Police Department
1 Police Plaza
New York, NY 10038

POLICE OFFICER JOHN ROE
New York City Police Department
1 Police Plaza
New York, NY 10038

**SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF BRONX**

CHRISTIAN RIVERA,

INDEX NO.:

Plaintiff,

– against –

VERIFIED COMPLAINT

**CITY OF NEW YORK, NEW YORK CITY POLICE
DEPARTMENT, POLICE OFFICER VICTOR
MARRERO, POLICE OFFICER JOHN DOE and
POLICE OFFICER JOHN ROE,**

Defendant(s).

Plaintiff, by his attorney, **NEIL WOLLERSTEIN, ESQ.**, complaining of the defendants, respectfully shows to this Court and alleges the following upon information and belief:

1. That at all times the Plaintiff **CHRISTIAN RIVERA** was and is a resident of Bronx County, State of New York.

2. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, the defendant, CITY OF NEW YORK, hereinafter referred to as “CITY”, was and still is a municipal corporation organized and existing under and by virtue of the laws of the State of New York.

3. That at all times hereinafter mentioned the defendant, NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT, hereinafter referred to as “NYPD”, was and is an agency of the defendant, CITY.

4. That on and prior to 1/20/15 and at all times hereinafter mentioned the defendant, POLICE OFFICER VICTOR MARRERO (Shield No. 20392), hereinafter referred to as “MARRERO” was and is a police officer employed by the defendant NYPD, and at all times herein was acting in such capacity as the agent, servant and employee of the CITY and NYPD.

5. That on and prior to 1/20/15 and at all times hereinafter mentioned the defendant, POLICE OFFICER JOHN DOE, hereinafter referred to as “DOE” was and is a police officer

employed by the defendant NYPD, and at all times herein was acting in such capacity as the agent, servant and employee of the CITY and NYPD.

6. That on and prior to 1/20/15 and at all times hereinafter mentioned the defendant, POLICE OFFICER JOHN ROE, hereinafter referred to as “ROE” was and is a police officer employed by the defendant NYPD, and at all times herein was acting in such capacity as the agent, servant and employee of the CITY and NYPD.

7. Upon information and belief, at all times hereinafter mentioned, and on 1/20/15, at approximately 7:30 p.m., several police officers including but not limited to MARRERO, DOE and ROE were on duty and in the vicinity of 844 Hunts Point Avenue, County of Bronx, City and State of New York.

8. Upon information and belief, at all times hereinafter mentioned, and on 1/20/15, at approximately 7:30 p.m., the above mentioned Police Officers were acting within the scope of their employment and under the direction of the CITY and NYPD as its agents, servants and/or employees.

9. Upon information and belief, defendants MARRERO, DOE and ROE were all assigned to the 41st Precinct.

10. That on and prior to 1/20/15, MARRERO, DOE and ROE were each individually hired, screened, tested, interviewed, trained, retrained, investigated, monitored and supervised by the CITY and NYPD.

11. That on and prior to 1/20/15, at approximately 7:30 p.m., and all relevant times herein after, MARRERO, DOE and ROE individually and/or collectively were acting pursuant to and under the rules and regulations of the New York City Patrol Guidelines.

12. That on 1/20/15, at approximately, 7:30 p.m., Plaintiff **CHRISTIAN RIVERA** was

lawfully in the vicinity of 844 Hunts Point Avenue, County of Bronx, City and State of New York and doing nothing illegal, improper or acting suspicious in anyway.

13. That on 1/20/15, at approximately, 7:30 p.m., in the vicinity of 844 Hunts Point Avenue, County of Bronx, City and State of New York, MARRERO, DOE and ROE, absent an arrest warrant, probable cause, reasonable cause or any legal justification, approached Plaintiff **CHRISTIAN RIVERA** for no reason and summarily stopped, searched, grabbed, assaulted, battered, and detained him in an aggressive and excessive manner.

14. Upon information and belief MARRERO, DOE and ROE knew or had reason to know that their actions lacked any legal justification in approaching, searching, seizing and arresting Plaintiff **CHRISTIAN RIVERA** and that there actions were based on fraud, perjury and misrepresentations.

15. Upon information and belief, Plaintiff **CHRISTIAN RIVERA** was subjected to a strip search while in the custody of defendants without any legal reason or justification.

16. That Plaintiff **CHRISTIAN RIVERA** was arraigned after his arrest and thereafter falsely and maliciously prosecuted with committing a crime.

17. Thereafter, Plaintiff **CHRISTIAN RIVERA** remained incarcerated for over 24 hours and was required to make numerous court appearances over an extended period of time until all charges against him were terminated favorably.

18. Plaintiff **CHRISTIAN RIVERA** sustained physical and emotional pain and injuries as a result of this incident.

19. That within ninety (90) days after the causes of actions accrued herein, and more than thirty (30) days prior to the commencement of this action, the Plaintiff **CHRISTIAN RIVERA** caused the notice of claim, in writing, sworn to by and on behalf of the claimants, the Plaintiff

herein, containing the statement of the name and place of residence of the claimants by the street and number and their attorney, and describing the time when the particular claim and circumstances under which the damages and injuries were sustained, the cause thereof, and so far as practical, the nature and extent of the injuries to be personally served upon the defendant CITY, their agents, servants and/or employees at the Law Department,

20. This action was so commenced within one (1) year and ninety (90) days after said cause of action accrued herein, and for more than thirty (30) days prior to the commencement of this action, defendant CITY neglected, refused and failed to make an adjustment of said claim, and said claim remains unadjusted and unpaid, although plaintiff herein has requested and demanded that the same be paid and adjusted.

21. That more than thirty (30) days have elapsed since the service and filing of a Notice of Claim with the Comptroller of the City of New York and said entity has stipulated that plaintiff may commence the instant action prior to the holding of a hearing pursuant to Section 50-h of the General Municipal Law.

**AS AND FOR A FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF CHRISTIAN RIVERA**

22. Plaintiff **CHRISTIAN RIVERA** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1 – 21 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth at length herein.

23. That on or about 1/20/15, at approximately 7:30 p.m., the Plaintiff **CHRISTIAN RIVERA** was without just cause, probable cause or provocation, and with reckless, negligent and callous disregard for the truth, and without investigation, touched, grabbed, handcuffed, seized and arrested in an excessive manner and with excessive force by CITY, NYPD, MARRERO, DOE and

ROE, their agents, servants and/or employees, and in particular, by MARRERO, DOE and ROE.

24. That on or about 1/20/15, at approximately 7:30 p.m., the Plaintiff **CHRISTIAN RIVERA** while lawfully in the vicinity of 844 Hunts Point Avenue, County of Bronx, City and State of New York, was without just cause, probable cause or provocation, maliciously, intentionally and falsely accused by CITY, NYPD, MARRERO, DOE and ROE of having committed a crime.

25. That on or about 1/20/15, and upon arresting the Plaintiff **CHRISTIAN RIVERA** and depriving him of his liberty, CITY, NYPD, MARRERO, DOE and ROE took the Plaintiff **CHRISTIAN RIVERA** to a police station in the County of Bronx and entered him on the records as under arrest.

26. That on or about 1/20/15, the CITY, NYPD, MARRERO, DOE and ROE further caused Plaintiff **CHRISTIAN RIVERA** to have his fingerprints and photographs to be taken without his consent and in accordance with police procedures for the arrest of criminals and held him on various criminal charges at various police stations, correctional facilities and at a courthouse located in the County of Bronx, City and State of New York.

27. That on or about 1/20/15 Plaintiff **CHRISTIAN RIVERA** was aware of his arrest and confinement, he did not consent to his arrest or confinement, and said confinement, seizure, arrest and detention was without legal justification.

28. That at all times hereinafter mentioned the actions of CITY, NYPD, MARRERO, DOE and ROE as described above were carried out in a reckless, deliberate, willful, wanton, malicious and grossly negligent manner.

29. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **CHRISTIAN RIVERA** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

AS AND FOR A SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF CHRISTIAN RIVERA

30. Plaintiff **CHRISTIAN RIVERA** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1 – 29 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth at length herein.

31. That on or about 1/20/15, a criminal complaint was issued by the CITY, NYPD, MARRERO, DOE and ROE, their agents, servants and/or employees, without probable cause, reasonable cause or legal justification.

32. That on or about 1/20/15 a criminal action against Plaintiff **CHRISTIAN RIVERA** was commenced by CITY, NYPD, MARRERO, DOE and ROE, their agents, servants and/or employees, without probable cause, reasonable cause or legal justification.

33. That solely as a result of the aforesaid, the Plaintiff **CHRISTIAN RIVERA'S** life was interfered with.

34. That the criminal action against Plaintiff **CHRISTIAN RIVERA** was continued for an extended period of time by defendants with malice and bad faith.

35. That solely as a result of the false arrest, assault, battery, false imprisonment and malicious prosecution of the Plaintiff **CHRISTIAN RIVERA**, he was deprived of his liberty for an extended period of time and was subjected to scorn, ridicule, embarrassment and was degraded in the esteem of the community both personally and professionally.

36. That the criminal action against Plaintiff **CHRISTIAN RIVERA** was terminated favorably by dismissal.

37. That the actions of CITY, NYPD, MARRERO, DOE and ROE as described above were carried out in a reckless, deliberate, willful, wanton, malicious and grossly negligent manner.

38. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **CHRISTIAN RIVERA** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

**AS AND FOR A THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF CHRISTIAN RIVERA**

39. Plaintiff **CHRISTIAN RIVERA** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1 - 38 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth at length herein.

40. That on or about 1/20/15, and while in the custody of the defendants in the County of Bronx, City of New York, the Plaintiff **CHRISTIAN RIVERA** was intentionally touched, pushed, assaulted, battered, violated, strip searched, humiliated, photographed and handcuffed by the CITY, NYPD, MARRERO, DOE and ROE, who were acting within the scope of their employment and authority in such a manner as to knowingly cause injury to plaintiff.

41. That on or about 1/20/15 CITY, NYPD, MARRERO, DOE and ROE, their agents, servants and employees, acting as agents and on behalf of the CITY, NYPD, MARRERO, DOE and ROE, within the scope of their employment, did intentionally, willfully and maliciously assault and batter the Plaintiff **CHRISTIAN RIVERA** in that they have the real or apparent ability to cause imminent harmful and/or offensive bodily contact and intentionally did a violent and/or menacing act which threatened such contact to the Plaintiff **CHRISTIAN RIVERA** and their act caused apprehension of such contact in the plaintiff, and in a hostile and/or offensive manner touched and beat the plaintiff and/or offensive bodily contact to the Plaintiff **CHRISTIAN RIVERA** and caused such battery in and about his head, neck, back, body and limbs.

42. That by reason of the aforesaid intentional assault and battery which was committed in an excessive manner and with excessive force and without legal justification or privilege by the

defendants, their agents, servants and employees, who were acting within the scope of their employment and authority and without any probable or reasonable cause, Plaintiff **CHRISTIAN RIVERA** suffered great and permanent bodily injury in and about his head, neck, back, body and limbs and was rendered sick, sore, lame and disabled, and suffered conscious pain and suffering, and that he was otherwise damaged.

43. That as a result of the aforesaid assault and battery the Plaintiff **CHRISTIAN RIVERA** was caused to sustain serious, severe, painful and permanent bodily injuries so that he was rendered sick, sore, lame and disabled and so remains and was and will be compelled to seek medical aid and attention and incur expenses for same in an endeavor to cure himself of his said injuries and he was and will be prevented from attending his usual occupation and duties.

44. That at all times hereinafter mentioned the actions of CITY, NYPD, MARRERO, DOE and ROE as described above were carried out in a reckless, deliberate, willful, wanton, malicious and grossly negligent manner.

45. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **CHRISTIAN RIVERA** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

**AS AND FOR A FOURTH CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF CHRISTIAN RIVERA**

46. Plaintiff **CHRISTIAN RIVERA** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1 – 45 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth at length herein.

47. That the CITY, NYPD, their agents, servants and employees were negligent, careless and reckless in hiring, retaining, training, monitoring, retraining, supervising and promoting its employees including but not limited to MARRERO, DOE and ROE, in that said police officers, as

employees of CITY and NYPD, were not qualified to be hired or retained or promoted as police officers, lacked the experience, skill, training and ability to be employed, retained and utilized in the manner that each was employed by CITY and NYPD.

48. That the CITY and NYPD failed to exercise due care and caution in its hiring, retaining, training and/or promoting practices in that CITY and NYPD failed to adequately test, analyze test results, and/or investigate above mentioned police officers backgrounds and performances.

49. That the CITY and NYPD failed to exercise due care and caution in its hiring, retaining, training and/or promoting practices in that CITY and NYPD failed to adequately screen said police officers, failed to adequately monitor said police officers, and failed to adequately discipline said police officers when they violate Patrol Guidelines.

50. Defendant CITY and NYPD were also negligent in that prior to and at the time of the acts complained of herein, due to the prior history of the police officer defendants named herein, knew or should have known of the bad disposition of said defendants, or at the very least had knowledge of facts that would put a reasonably prudent employer on inquiry concerning their bad disposition and the fact that defendant police officers were not suitable to be hired and employed by the CITY and NYPD and that due to their lack of training, these officers should have had adequate supervision so that they would not arrest innocent individuals nor use excessive force during the arrest process.

51. That by reason of the above, the Plaintiff **CHRISTIAN RIVERA** was injured in mind and body as he was arrested, prosecuted and rendered sick, sore, and damaged.

52. That at all times hereinafter mentioned the actions of CITY, NYPD and all defendants herein as described above were carried out in a reckless, deliberate, willful, wanton, malicious and

grossly negligent manner.

53. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **CHRISTIAN RIVERA** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

AS AND FOR A FIFTH CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF CHRISTIAN RIVERA

54. Plaintiff **CHRISTIAN RIVERA** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1-53 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth at length herein.

55. In arresting Plaintiff **CHRISTIAN RIVERA**, police officers including but not limited to MARRERO, DOE and ROE, acting in their capacity as agents, servants and employees of CITY and NYPD, were motivated by an ulterior purpose to do harm, without justification or economic or social excuse.

56. In arresting Plaintiff **CHRISTIAN RIVERA**, police officers including but not limited to MARRERO, DOE and ROE, acting in their capacity as agents, servants and employees of CITY and NYPD, sought either a detriment to Plaintiff **CHRISTIAN RIVERA** or a collateral advantage to the CITY and NYPD that is outside the legitimate ends of effectuating an arrest.

57. As a result of the abuse of process by defendants herein, Plaintiff **CHRISTIAN RIVERA** sustained multiple injuries including but not limited to loss of liberty, emotional distress, humiliation, loss of enjoyment of life, and fear and intimidation for his safety.

58. That at all times hereinafter mentioned the actions of CITY, NYPD and all defendants herein as described above were carried out in a reckless, deliberate, willful, wanton, malicious and grossly negligent manner.

59. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **CHRISTIAN RIVERA** has been damaged

in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

WHEREFORE, the Plaintiff **CHRISTIAN RIVERA** demands judgment against the defendants on the First Cause of Action through the Fifth Cause of Action in a sum that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state for each cause of action, all together with attorney's fees, punitive damages and the costs and disbursements of this action.

Dated: Bronx, New York
 March 9, 2016

Yours, etc.,



NEIL WOLLERSTEIN, ESQ.

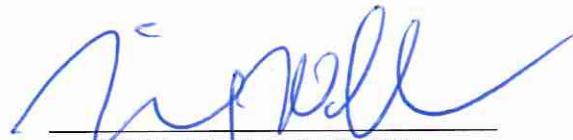
Attorney for Plaintiff
895 Sheridan Avenue
Bronx, New York 10451
(718) 588-1300

ATTORNEY VERIFICATION

NEIL WOLLERSTEIN, an attorney duly admitted to practice before the courts of the State of New York affirms the following to be true pursuant to CPLR 2106 and under the penalties of perjury:

1. The undersigned, an attorney admitted to practice in the Courts of the State of New York states that he is retained on behalf of plaintiff **CHRISTIAN RIVERA**.
2. That affirmant has read the foregoing **SUMMONS and VERIFIED COMPLAINT** and knows the contents thereof; that the same is true to affirmant's own knowledge except as to the matters therein stated to be alleged on information and belief; and that as to those matters affirmant believes them to be true.
3. Your affirmant further says that the reason this verification is made by affirmant and not the plaintiff is that the plaintiff is not currently available.

Dated: Bronx, New York
March 9, 2016



NEIL WOLLERSTEIN

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF BRONX

CHRISTIAN RIVERA,

Plaintiff,

– against –

**CITY OF NEW YORK, NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT, POLICE OFFICER
VICTOR MARRERO, POLICE OFFICER JOHN DOE and POLICE OFFICER JOHN ROE,**

Defendant(s).

SUMMONS AND VERIFIED COMPLAINT

NEIL WOLLERSTEIN, ESQ.

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895 Sheridan Avenue
Bronx, New York 10451
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